



3 neutrons are produced.

- (b) From the graph U has lower binding energy per nucleon than the products Ba and Kr. Multiplying by the number of nucleons, U has lower binding energy than both (Ba + Kr) together.

This means that U required less energy to break up the nucleus into its constituent nucleons, and more energy is being released when both Ba + Kr are formed from the constituent nucleons. Hence overall, there is a net release of energy.

- (c) Energy required to break U = $7.63 \times 235 = 1793 \text{ MeV}$
 Energy released when Ba + Kr formed = $8.40 \times 141 + 8.70 \times 92 = 1985 \text{ MeV}$
 Net energy released = $1985 - 1793 = 192 \text{ MeV}$.

- (d) Neutron is a free particle and has no binding energy. Thus it is not included in the calculation.